

Configuration

Head over to the *Apache24* installation directory and navigate to the folder named *htdocs*. This is called the document root. This is where your files reside — those that are to be hosted and that will be served by Apache. You will find a single *index.html* file available inside it. *index.html* is the first file Apache looks for by default if you do not mention a file name. For example, *www.example.com/* will actually be served by *www.example.com/index.html*.

Replace the contents of *index.html* with your own content. You can add your files here and host your website on Apache. You can also access your website on the same network by typing the IP address of your host computer in another computer's browser in the same network.

However, if you'd like to change the document root, you can do that by going back to *Apache24/conf/httpd.conf*. Find the line that starts with *DocumentRoot*. It should look something like what's shown below:

```
# DocumentRoot: The directory out of
# which you will serve your
# documents. By default, all requests
# are taken from this directory, but
# symbolic links and aliases may be
# used to point to other locations.
#
```

```
DocumentRoot "${SRVROOT}/htdocs"
<Directory "${SRVROOT}/htdocs">
```

We just have to change the directory to the location you desire. For this tutorial, I will point my new document root to *C:\web*. Make sure you have copied your files with an appropriate *index.html* to the new location. Now edit the *httpd.conf* file to:

```
DocumentRoot "C:/web"
<Directory "C:/web">
```

Notice the *'/'* forward slash has been used rather than the Windows backward slash.

Save the file and restart the server by going to *Windows Services*. Now try loading *localhost* again and it should display your *index.html* from the new document root.

Installing PHP

Downloading the files

Downloading PHP is pretty straightforward. You just need to head over to the PHP Windows site at <https://windows.php.net/download/> and download the latest stable thread safe binaries. At the time of writing this, the latest stable version is PHP 7.3.10 for Win64.

Download and extract the Zip file to an appropriate location. I will be extracting it to *C:\php7*. Use the location where you extracted PHP in *httpd.conf*.

Preparing Apache for PHP

Apache needs to be configured to communicate with PHP to be able to serve dynamic Web pages from PHP. For this, we need to prepare Apache to be able to find the PHP interpreter. Add the following code to the top of *httpd.conf*:

```
AddHandler application/x-httpd-php .php
AddType application/x-httpd-php .php
LoadModule php7_module "c:/php7/
php7apache2_4.dll"
PHPIniDir "c:/php7"
```

This configuration tells Apache to redirect all requests to pages ending with *.php* to the PHP interpreter with the module located at *C:\php7\php7apache2_4.dll*.

Configuring PHP

We will now need to configure PHP to be able to handle the pages. For this, PHP comes with two sets of configurations — one for development and the other for production. Since we are building the system for development, we will use the development configuration, which allows PHP to explicitly throw errors on the Web

PHP Version 7.3.10	
	
System	Windows NT DESKTOP-VCB390N 10.0 build 10240 (Windows 10) AMD64
Build Date	Sep 24 2019 11:51:12
Compiler	MSVC15 (Visual C++ 2017)
Architecture	x64
Configure Command	cscript /nologo configure.js "--enable-snapshot-build" "--enable-debug-pack" "--with-pdo-oci=c:\php-snap-build\deps_aux\oracle\x64\instantclient_12_1\sdk,shared" "--with-oci8-12c=c:\php-snap-build\deps_aux\oracle\x64\instantclient_12_1\sdk,shared" "--enable-object-out-dir=../obj/" "--enable-com-dotnet=shared" "--without-analyzer" "--with-pgo"
Server API	Apache 2.0 Handler
Virtual Directory Support	enabled
Configuration File (php.ini) Path	C:\Windows
Loaded Configuration File	C:\php7\php.ini

Figure 3: PHP configuration page